Yuyuan Yu

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EDUCATION

City University of Hong Kong 2022–2027 (Expected)
PhD Candidate in Economics Hong Kong
Dissertation: Two Essays on International Trade and Environmental Economics
Advisor: Hanwei Huang

Central University of Finance and Economics 2018–2020
MA in Economics Beijing, China
Dissertation: Impacts of Financial Openness on Economic Complexity
Advisor: Dahai Fu

Zhongnan University of Economics and Law 2014–2018
BA in Economics Wuhan, China

RESEARCH INTERESTS

General interests: International Trade, Environmental, Urban and Development Economics

Special focus: Trade policy, firm dynamics, transportation, crime, and pollutants

JOB MARKET PAPER

"Evading the Ban: Smuggling, Pollution, and Firm Performance Under Waste Import Restrictions", with Hanwei Huang, R&R at *Journal of International Economics* (selected for the International Seminar on Trade 2026).

Abstract: While import restrictions are increasingly deployed to achieve non-trade objectives such as environmental protection, they often create distortions and leakage through illicit trade. We examine this trade-off in the context of China's waste import ban. Although the policy produced measurable reductions in pollution, it also induced significant behavioral responses, including surging evasion via quantity underreporting, heightened smuggling-related criminal activity, and deteriorating performance among affected firms. To quantify the welfare effects, we develop a hybrid sufficient-statistic framework that integrates reduced-form evasion elasticities with structural estimates of shadow costs. We find that the environmental gains more than offset the costs of smuggling and losses from distortions.

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

[1] **Yu, Y.**, Qayyum, M., and Li, S. (2024). Trade dynamics of environmental goods within global energy economy and their impacts on green technological innovation: A complex network analysis. *Energy Economics*, 140, 107957.

[2] Zhang, Y., Qayyum, M., and **Yu, Y.** (2023). Effects of resource abundance on economic complexity: Evidence from spatial panel model. *Journal of Cleaner Production*, 427, 139134.

[3] **Yu, Y.**, and Qayyum, M. (2023). Impacts of financial openness on economic complexity: Cross-country evidence. *International Journal of Finance and Economics*, 28(2), 1514-1526.

WORK IN PROGRESS

"Dam Good for Trade", with Hanwei Huang, Yu-Hsiang Lei, and Yan Lei.

FELLOWSHIP AND AWARDS

Postgraduate Student Scholarship, City University of Hong Kong 2022-2026

Outstanding Academic Performance Award, City University of Hong Kong 2025

PRESENTATIONS

Allied Social Science Associations (ASSA) Annual Meeting, Washington (planned) 2027

Asian Economic Development Conference (AEDC), Hong Kong 2026

Asia Meeting of the Econometric Society, East & Southeast Asia (AMES-E/SE), Hanoi

12th Hong Kong Economic Association (HKEA) Biennial Conference, Macau

Singapore Management University (SMU) Trade Conference, Singapore

Economics Brown Bag, City University of Hong Kong 2025

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

City University of Hong Kong - Teaching Assistant

Advanced Macroeconomics, Managing Your Personal Finance 2026

Microeconomics, Macroeconomics, Green Economics, International Finance 2023

Microeconomics 2022

REFEREE SERVICE

Applied Economics, Asia-Pacific Journal of Accounting and Economics, Review of Development Economics

OTHERS

Citizenship: Chinese

Programming Languages: Stata, ArcGIS, LaTex, Python

Languages: English (fluent), Mandarin (native)

REFEREES

Hanwei Huang (Supervisor)
Assistant Professor
Department of Economics and Finance
City University of Hong Kong
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Stephen Teng Sun
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Dahai Fu
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Jin Zhou
Associate Professor
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